

IRCTC E-Ticketing: Service Guidelines & Terms of Use

This document provides a comprehensive overview of the rules, procedures, and terms governing the use of the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) online booking platform, including user obligations and detailed transaction policies.

1. Service Definitions

The IRCTC platform supports three primary types of ticketing:

1.1 User Registration Obligations

Individual users must provide valid personal details including a unique mobile number and email ID during registration. It is the user's responsibility to keep their login credentials secure and update their profile with correct information to ensure seamless communication and service delivery.

- **E-Ticket:** A digital reservation where the Electronic Reservation Slip (ERS), combined with a valid photo ID, constitutes the authority to travel.
- **I-Ticket:** A railway reservation booked online but printed on standard railway stationery. Delivery is restricted to select cities via courier and requires a valid address. The ticket must be booked at least 2 to 3 days in advance depending on the delivery location.
- **Tatkal Ticket:** Tickets booked against a specific Tatkal quota for short-notice travel, subject to premium charges.

2. General Booking Rules and Limitations

2.1 Service Hours

Booking through the internet is available from 00:20 AM to 11:45 PM (IST) daily. Opening day bookings (120 days in advance) commence at **08:00 AM**.

2.2 Capacity and Quotas

- **Passenger Limit:** A maximum of six berths/seats can be booked per transaction.
- **Monthly Limit:** Individual users are restricted to booking a maximum of six tickets in a calendar month.
- **Available Quotas:** General (GN), Senior Citizen (SS), Ladies (LD), and Tatkal (CK).
- **Concessions:** No concessions are permitted for internet bookings except for Senior Citizens.

3. Services Summary

3.1 Services Offered

- Booking of I-Tickets, E-Tickets, and Tatkal tickets.
- Automated up-gradation to the next higher class (on an optional basis).
- Online cancellation for E-Tickets only (until chart preparation).
- General enquiries regarding accommodation availability, PNR status, timetables, and fares.

3.2 Services NOT Offered

- Reservation on Police/Military warrants or Railway passes.
- Modification or online cancellation of I-Tickets (must be done at PRS counters).
- Issue of duplicate tickets for lost or mutilated I-Tickets.
- Reservation for tickets with "Break Journey."

- Bulk bookings for large groups or families.

4. Identification Requirements

To travel on an E-Ticket or receive an I-Ticket, at least one passenger per PNR must present one of the following **original** identity proofs. Failure to produce original ID results in being treated as traveling without a ticket:

1. Aadhaar Card
2. Voter Photo Identity Card
3. Passport
4. Driving License
5. PAN Card
6. Student Identity Card (with photograph) from a recognized School/College
7. Nationalized Bank Passbook (with photograph)
8. Credit Cards with laminated photograph
9. Photo ID issued by Central/State Government (e.g., PPO, BPL card)
10. Pension Pay Orders (PPO)

4.1 Specific Journey ID Requirements

The ID proof name must match the name on the reservation slip. For Senior Citizen concessions, proof of age is mandatory during the journey.

5. Cancellation and Refund Policies

5.1 E-Tickets

Cancellation can be performed online through the "Booked Tickets" link until the preparation of the reservation chart. Refunds are credited back to the original payment account.

5.2 I-Tickets

Online cancellation is **not possible**. The physical ticket must be submitted at a Railway Reservation (PRS) counter. While the refund is processed electronically, the physical receipt is issued at the counter.

5.4 Failed Transactions and Technical Errors

If money is debited but the ticket is not generated due to technical reasons, the full amount is automatically refunded to the user's account within 7-10 business days. Users are advised not to attempt multiple bookings until the status is confirmed.

5.5 Late Cancellations and TDR

For cancellations after chart preparation, users must file a Ticket Deposit Receipt (TDR) online. Refunds for late cancellations are subject to verification by the Zonal Railways and are not guaranteed for all cases.

5.3 Tatkal Tickets

- **Confirmed Tickets:** No refund is granted upon cancellation of confirmed Tatkal tickets.
- **Waitlisted Tickets:** Refunds are processed after deducting clerkage charges as per railway rules.

6. Tatkal Charges

Tatkal charges are calculated as a percentage of the basic fare (10% for Second Class, 30% for all others), subject to the following minimum and maximum limits:

Class of Travel	Min Charges (₹)	Max Charges (₹)	Min Distance for Charge (Km)
Second (Sitting)	10	15	100
Sleeper	100	200	500

Class of Travel	Min Charges (₹)	Max Charges (₹)	Min Distance for Charge (Km)
AC Chair Car	125	225	250
AC 3 Tier	300	400	500
AC 2 Tier	400	500	500
Executive	400	500	250

7. Mumbai Suburban Season Tickets

Registered users may book Mumbai Suburban Season Tickets online with the following conditions:

- **Advance Booking:** Between 2 and 10 days in advance of the start date.
- **Delivery:** Limited to courier delivery in Mumbai, Nashik, Pune, Surat, and Thane.
- **Restrictions:** No cancellations, refunds, or modifications are permitted once booked.
- **Validity:** Valid only when accompanied by the original railway-issued photo identity card.

8. Support and Contact Information

For assistance or grievances, users may contact the 24/7 Customer Support:

- **General Enquiries:** care@irctc.co.in
- **Phone Support:** 011-39340000
- **E-Ticket Specific Claims:** etickets@irctc.co.in
- **Season Ticket Enquiries:** seasontickets@irctc.co.in